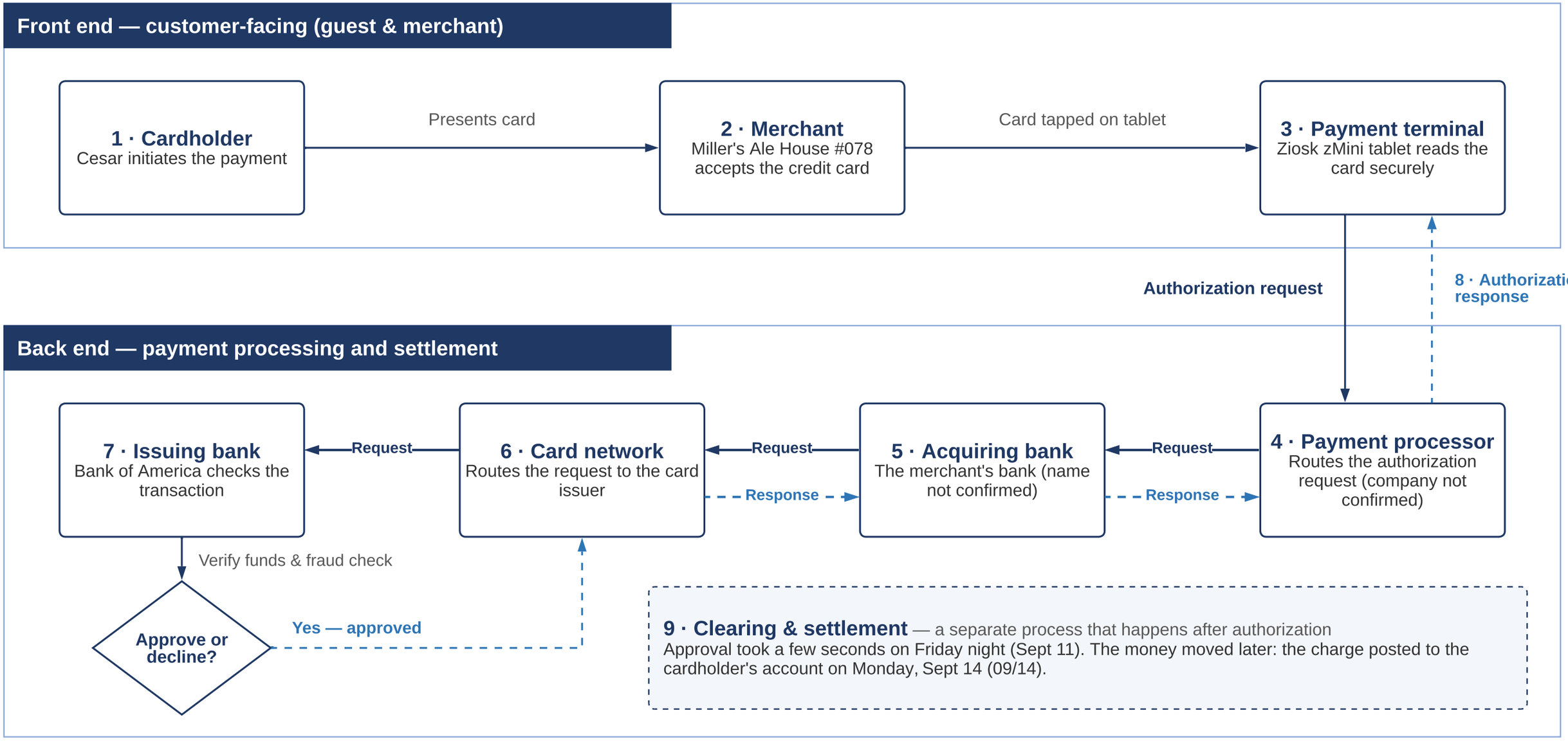
Credit Card Transaction Journey Map

Miller's Ale House #078, Brandon, FL · Friday, September 11, 2026 · $50.14 · Bank of America credit card · Card-present (POS) purchase



Legend: solid arrow = authorization request · dashed arrow = authorization response · Payment processor and acquiring bank are labeled by role because their names are not publicly confirmed.

Credit Card Transaction Journey — Notes & Research

Written explanation and research notes supporting the transaction diagram on Page 1

Transaction Overview

On Friday, September 11, 2026, I ate at Miller's Ale House #078 in Brandon, Florida. My bill was $50.14 and I paid with my Bank of America credit card on the small tablet at the table. The charge showed up on my account on Monday, September 14.

Payment Type

This was a point-of-sale (POS) purchase. I was at the restaurant in person and my card was read by the restaurant's own device, so it counts as “card present.” That matters because card-present sales have lower fees and less fraud risk than online ones.

It was not an online purchase, not a person-to-person transfer, and not a remittance.

What I Used

A Bank of America credit card, tapped on the tablet at the table.

Who Was Involved

- Me — I started the payment and approved the amount.
- Miller's Ale House — the restaurant that sold me the food.
- The Ziosk tablet — read my card and sent the information out securely.
- Payment processor — passes the request along. I could not find out which company this is.
- Acquiring bank — the restaurant's bank, where the money ends up. Also unknown.
- Card network — carries the request to my bank and sets the rules.
- Bank of America — my bank. It checked my credit limit, checked for fraud, and approved it.

What I Noticed

Two things I noticed:

- Because I paid at the table, I added the tip before approving, so the full $50.14 was approved at once. At a normal restaurant the server runs the card first and the tip gets added later.

- Getting approved and actually moving the money are two different steps: approval took a few seconds on Friday night, but the charge did not post until Monday.

Research Notes and Sources

Miller's Ale House uses Ziosk tablets at every location and PAR terminals for their registers.

Ziosk says on its own website that it is not a payment processor — it just connects to whichever one the restaurant picks, and it lists Fiserv, Worldpay, TSYS, Chase, Shift4, and FreedomPay as options.

I could not find out which one Miller's uses, and the same for their bank, because companies don't publish that. So I labeled those boxes by role instead of by name.

Sources

- Business Wire
- ziosk.com
- Hospitality Technology